arrived and then pass it on to another piece of middleware. Meanwhile, a static-file middleware component might spot an incoming request for an image with a specific name, load the image from disk, and send it back to the user without passing it on.

The most important piece of middleware in most ASP.NET Core applications is the `EndpointMiddleware` class. This class normally generates all your HTML and JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) responses, and is the focus of most of this book. Like image-resizing middleware, it typically receives a request, generates a response, and then sends it back to the user (figure 4.1).

